momentum that helped me win all but a few of the remaining primaries that spring.

Shortly after New Hampshire, all the candidates except George Bush dropped out, and then, near the end of May, he dropped out, too.

In early July, when Nancy and I arrived at the Republican National Convention in Detroit, it appeared I had more than enough delegate votes to win the nomination and the next thing on my agenda was choosing a running mate.

Even before we landed in Detroit, a number of party leaders and members of my own team such as Paul Laxalt had been talking up the possibility of asking Gerald Ford to run with me as the vice-presidential candidate. By the opening day of the convention, the idea had really taken on a momentum and everyone was calling it a “dream ticket.”

An ex-president, of course, had never run for vice-president before, but we had been through an unusual time in history, and I said I was in favor of it.

Members of our campaign team began quietly discussing the idea with Ford and some of the people close to him, and for a while it looked like the plan would fly. Then Paul Laxalt and some of the other people in our camp began coming back from the meetings with word there might be some problems with the dream ticket.

Some of Ford’s advisors were pushing for him to become a kind of “copresident” with responsibilities in foreign affairs and other areas much broader than those normally assigned a vice-president.

After news of our secret negotiations leaked out, Gerald Ford spoke to Walter Cronkite on CBS and during the interview hinted at some of the things that his people were proposing and said that if the plan went through, he expected to play a significant role with me in making White House decisions; well, as I watched the interview, it really hit me that we had some major problems with the idea: *Wait*